

# The 12-Week Visibility Assignment

One quarter, ten hours a week: own the local market for Sarajevo & Bosnia tours, and get found by travelers planning from the US, Canada, the UK & Ireland, German-speaking Europe, and Scandinavia.

**Site** tallesttourguide.com    **Budget** ~10 h/week    **Horizon** 12 weeks    **Written** July 2026

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| WEEKLY BUCKET                     | HOURS |
|-----------------------------------|-------|
| Content (1 journal post)          | 3.0   |
| Social (film, edit, post, engage) | 3.0   |
| Reviews + Google Business Profile | 1.5   |
| Outreach (links, listings, PR)    | 1.5   |
| Measurement + admin               | 1.0   |

## SECTION 0

### Where you stand

The technical foundation is already better than most tour operators ever get: every page is prerendered with unique titles, descriptions and canonical URLs; the sitemap and RSS feed regenerate on every deploy; tours carry Product, FAQ and Breadcrumb structured data; the site is fast and mobile-first; GA4, Search Console and the Google Business Profile are all live.

**Shipped in the July 2026 code batch** (deploy before starting Week 1):

- One email everywhere: `hello@tallesttourguide.com` — the footer previously showed the Gmail address, and name–address–phone consistency is a local-ranking factor.
- Business schema upgraded to **TravelAgency** with phone, email, the full street address (Hamdije Kreševljakovića 61, 71000), a map link, and Instagram + TripAdvisor profiles attached.

- New **Organization + WebSite** structured data on every page.
- Checkout and review-form pages marked `noindex ; /admin/` blocked in robots.txt.
- Every tour, package and journal post now shares with **its own hero photo** on WhatsApp, iMessage, Facebook and LinkedIn — previously a generic image, and journal share images were broken.
- Stale meta description on the multi-day-tours page fixed.

**One rule for everything below:** every URL you type anywhere on the internet uses the trailing-slash form, e.g. `https://tallesttourguide.com/tours/sarajevo-war-tour/` — that's the canonical form the site serves without a redirect.

## SECTION 1 · WEEK 1, ONE-TIME

# Command center setup

## 1.1 Google Search Console — you have it, now work it

- ☐ **Sitemap:** Indexing → Sitemaps. `sitemap.xml` should read **Success, 51 URLs**. If missing, type `sitemap.xml` and submit.
- ☐ **Page indexing sweep:** Indexing → Pages. "Page with redirect" on old `/blog/` URLs is correct — ignore. "Crawled – currently not indexed" on a tour or post means Google didn't find it worth indexing yet: strengthen the page and link to it from other pages. "Discovered – currently not indexed" usually resolves alone; recheck in two weeks.
- ☐ **Request indexing after the deploy:** URL Inspection → paste each money URL (all 10 tours, all 7 packages, the homepage, `/tours/`, `/multi-day-tours/`) → Request indexing. About 15 minutes; gets the new schema into the index days faster.
- ☐ **Baseline snapshot:** Performance → last 28 days → Export. Record total clicks, impressions, average position, top 20 queries. This is Week 0 — every KPI below measures against it.
- ☐ **Monthly ritual (calendar it):** Performance → filter Position > 8 → sort by impressions. These positions 8–20 queries are your cheapest wins: answer the query verbatim in a paragraph or heading on the ranking page, and interlink to that page.

## 1.2 Google Business Profile — the local-market weapon

Manage at [business.google.com](https://business.google.com) → "Tallest Tourguide & Friends".

- ☐ **Category:** primary **Tour operator**; secondary "Tour agency", "Walking tour organizer".
- ☐ **NAP check:** Hamdije Kreševljakovića 61, Sarajevo 71000 · +387 62 664 244 · <https://tallesttourguide.com/> · 08:00–20:00 daily. Identical everywhere, always.
- ☐ **Services:** add every tour (name, € price, 2–3 sentences) linking to its page with UTM, e.g. `.../tours/sarajevo-war-tour/?utm_source=google&utm_medium=organic&utm_campaign=gbp`.
- ☐ **Photos:** 20+ now, ~5/week forever — guests on tours (with permission), Baščaršija, the Tunnel, cooking-class food, and a straight-to-camera portrait of Almedin.

- ☐ **Q&A:** from a personal account, post the six questions guests always ask (winter tours? meeting point? kids on the war tour? private options? card or cash? booking lead time?) — answer each from the business account.
- ☐ **Review link:** dashboard → Ask for reviews → copy the short `g.page/r/...` link. Needed for Section 2.
- ☐ **Weekly Update post** (15 min/week): one photo + 100–150 words + a "Learn more" button to a tour page with the UTM. Reuse the week's best Instagram post.

## 1.3 The other engines — set once, mostly forget

- ☐ **Bing Webmaster Tools:** [bing.com/webmasters](https://bing.com/webmasters) → *Import from Google Search Console*. Ten minutes; covers Bing, DuckDuckGo, and the web answers in ChatGPT and Copilot, which read Bing's index. Confirm the sitemap imported.
- ☐ **Bing Places:** [bingplaces.com](https://bingplaces.com) → import from Google Business Profile.
- ☐ **Apple Business Connect:** [businessconnect.apple.com](https://businessconnect.apple.com) → claim the Sarajevo place card. Apple Maps is the default on most of your US/UK/Nordic guests' iPhones. Match NAP exactly.
- ☐ **GA4 key events:** Admin → Events → mark `begin_checkout` and `purchase` as key events (the site already fires `view_item`, `begin_checkout`, `purchase`, `scroll_depth`, `cta_click`). Reports then show which channels produce bookings, not just visits.
- ☐ **Ahrefs Webmaster Tools** (free): verify via GSC; free backlink profile + technical crawl. Check monthly.
- ☐ **Schema check:** run one tour and one package through [search.google.com/test/rich-results](https://search.google.com/test/rich-results) — expect Product, FAQ and Breadcrumb eligibility. Re-run after any schema change.
- ☐ **Speed baseline:** [pagespeed.web.dev](https://pagespeed.web.dev) on the homepage and one tour page, mobile. File the scores with the Week-0 snapshot.

## SECTION 2 · WEEK 1 SETUP, THEN AUTOMATIC

# The review engine

### HIGHEST-LEVERAGE ITEM IN THIS PLAN

You have **4.9★ / 180 reviews on TripAdvisor** and far fewer on Google. Google review count and velocity are the #1 local-pack ranking factor — mirror the TripAdvisor momentum onto Google.

The evening after every tour, send each guest (or the group's booker) this WhatsApp message — you already have every guest on WhatsApp:

Hi {name}, Almedin here. It was a pleasure showing you {Sarajevo / Mostar / ...} today — I hope the rest of your trip is wonderful. If you have two minutes, a Google review helps a small local operation like ours more than you'd believe: {g.page/r/... link}

If you're more of a TripAdvisor person, that works too: {TripAdvisor link}. Safe travels! 🇧🇦

- Send it the **same evening** — memory fresh, trip ongoing, phone in hand.

- **One ask, Google link first;** alternate toward TripAdvisor once Google passes ~100 reviews.
- **Reply to every review within 48 hours**, named and specific ("Glad the Tunnel visit landed, Sarah"). Replies are a ranking signal and are read by every future guest.
- Never incentivize reviews — against Google policy, risks the whole profile.
- Track in a sheet: date, guest, sent, appeared. Target: **10+ new Google reviews/month** in season.

### SECTION 3 · WEEKS 2–4

## Listings & citations

Consistency beats volume: the same name, address, phone and website URL everywhere.

- ☐ **TripAdvisor polish:** refresh the description to mirror the site's positioning, confirm the website link, add 10 recent photos, list every tour you sell.

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- ☐ **GetYourGuide + Viator — list 2–3 hero tours** (Mostar day trip, war tour, walking tour). The ~20–30% commission is paid marketing: those listings rank on page 1 for "Sarajevo tours" in all four target markets (the billboard effect), reviews build fast, and OTA guests become direct bookers next trip via WhatsApp. Keep premium experiences — home-hosted dinner, Srebrenica, signature journeys — **direct-only**.

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- ☐ **Local BiH citations:** Visit Sarajevo / tourism-board directory, Sarajevo Navigator, Canton Sarajevo tourism association, national tourism portals. These .ba links double as your strongest local-relevance signals.

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- ☐ **Partner links (ongoing):** every hotel, hostel and guesthouse you work with has a "things to do" page. Ask each — you know them personally — to link "Guided tours: Tallest Tourguide". Aim for 5–10 this quarter.

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- ☐ **Facebook Page:** create it with full NAP — it's a citation, and it lets you join Balkan travel groups as the brand. One hour, once.

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### SECTION 4 · WEEKS 2–12, 3 H/WEEK

## Content engine — one journal post a week

Every post: 1,200–1,800 words in your existing voice (it's exactly right), one target query in the title and H1, a three-question FAQ block at the end, two or three internal links to tour or package pages plus one destination page, and a hero image with descriptive alt text. Publish through the admin CMS — the build pipeline handles sitemap, RSS, schema and share images automatically.

Titles below are the target query — check each against GSC and Google autocomplete before writing, and phrase the title the way people actually type.

| WK | POST                                                                    | TARGET QUERY / NOTE                                               |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2  | Is Bosnia and Herzegovina Safe to Visit in 2026? An Honest Local Answer | "is bosnia safe to visit" — the #1 hesitation in all four markets |
| 3  | Sarajevo in Two Days: A Local Guide's Perfect Itinerary                 | "2 days in sarajevo", "sarajevo itinerary"                        |
| 4  | Day Trips from Sarajevo, Ranked by the Guide Who Runs Them              | "day trips from sarajevo" — links every day-tour page             |
| 5  | Sarajevo to Mostar: Tour vs Bus vs Train vs Driving                     | "sarajevo to mostar" — big comparison query; be fair to the bus   |
| 6  | What to Eat in Sarajevo: 15 Dishes and Exactly Where to Find Them       | "sarajevo food" — feeds the cooking class                         |
| 7  | How Many Days Do You Need in Bosnia? 3, 5, 7 and 10-Day Routes          | "bosnia itinerary" — links all packages                           |
| 8  | Visiting Srebrenica: How to Do It, and How to Do It Respectfully        | supports the Srebrenica tour; same care as the existing post      |
| 9  | The Best Time to Visit Bosnia, Month by Month                           | "best time to visit bosnia" — Nordic/DACH summer planners         |
| 10 | Sarajevo Airport to the City: Every Option                              | "sarajevo airport to city" — high intent, zero competition        |
| 11 | Bosnia in Winter: What's Open, What's Worth It, What to Skip            | "bosnia in winter" — fills the low season                         |
| 12 | Ten Things I Tell Every Guest Before They Land in Sarajevo              | shareable; doubles as your pre-arrival WhatsApp asset             |

When a post goes live, spend ten minutes adding links **to it** from the two or three most related existing pages. Orphan posts don't rank.

**DACH & Scandinavia:** both markets read English travel content comfortably — no translated site this quarter. A single German landing page is a post-Week-12 experiment, only if GSC shows meaningful German-language impressions.

## SECTION 5 • 3 H/WEEK

# Social media system

**Film once, publish four times.** Instagram (@tallest.tourguide) is the hub; every vertical video is uploaded natively to TikTok, Facebook Reels and YouTube Shorts — same caption, no watermarks.

- 3 vertical videos/week (30–60 s), filmed on tour days on your phone.
- Stories 3–4x/week — behind-the-scenes, guest moments, polls.
- 1 Google Business Profile Update/week, reusing the best video's photo and text.

- Pinterest: one batch session/month — 10–15 pins from journal images linking to the posts ("Bosnia itinerary", "Sarajevo food" boards). Pinterest is search, not social: pins compound for years and skew to your US market.

## Five pillars — rotate, never invent a sixth

- **Place, told properly** — 45 seconds on the Mostar bridge divers, the Sarajevo roses, Baščaršija at dawn.
- **Guide to camera** — one historical mini-story ("WWI started on this corner — here's the part the textbooks skip"). Nobody can copy your delivery; this is the differentiator.
- **Food** — burek, ćevapi, the coffee ritual. The highest-share-rate travel content there is.
- **Guests** — reactions, group moments, review screenshots (with permission).
- **Practical answers** — the journal calendar's queries in 30 seconds ("Is Bosnia safe? I've guided here 14 years — honest answer:"). These convert.

**Timing:** 18:00–20:00 CET weekdays — evening for UK/IE/DACH/Scandinavia, lunchtime US East Coast. Second slot: Sunday 10:00 CET, trip-planning time.

**Community (20 min/day max):** r/travel, r/Sarajevo, r/Balkans and the big Bosnia/Balkan travel Facebook groups — as a helpful local, never an advertiser. Mention the site only when someone literally asks for a guide. One genuinely helpful Reddit answer outranks weeks of self-promotion, and those threads are exactly what ChatGPT and Google's AI answers quote when someone asks "best tour guide in Sarajevo".

## SECTION 6 · WEEKS 4–12, ~2 PITCHES/WEEK

# Backlinks & digital PR

- **Bloggers who already wrote about Bosnia** (search "things to do in sarajevo" blog): pitch a correction or addition as a local guide, or offer a hosted tour on their next visit. Goal: a mention + link as "local guide".
- **Journalist platforms:** free source profiles on **Qwoted**, **Source of Sources** and **Featured.com**. Answer 2–3 travel/Balkans requests a week, ten minutes each. One landed quote in a "where to go in 2027" piece is a top-tier link.
- **Podcasts:** pitch 4–5 travel shows with "14 years guiding Sarajevo: what visitors get wrong about Bosnia". One booking = a link plus an hour of trust.
- **Partner hotels** (Section 3) — keep asking; the most reliable link source you have.
- **Track it:** date, target, angle, sent, reply, link URL. Quarter target: **8–12 new referring domains** (Ahrefs, monthly).

## SECTION 7

# Dev backlog

## P1 — weeks 3–6, one session each

- CMS `metaTitle` / `metaDescription` fields for tours, packages, destinations, journal — admin editors plus detail-page wiring, falling back to today's auto-derived text. Unlocks per-page optimization from the GSC striking-distance ritual.
- FAQs for packages — data + reuse the existing FAQ schema component on package pages.
- Destination pages: expand each of the 8 from teaser-length to real 800+ word guides.

## P2 — after Week 12, as results justify

- Show real guest reviews on tour pages (the review flow already collects them) with Review schema.
- German landing-page experiment, if GSC shows German queries.

- Populate accommodations data and make Where We Stay data-driven when real content exists.
- Move the Airtable token out of the client bundle (it ships in public JS today; proxy admin writes through a serverless function). Security, not SEO — do it before the site gets attention.

SECTION 8

# The 12-week calendar

| WK | FOCUS                 | SHIP LIST                                                                                                    |
|----|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Command center        | Deploy code batch · Sections 1.1–1.3 complete · Week-0 baseline recorded · review template + link ready      |
| 2  | Reviews + first post  | Review engine live after every tour · <i>Is Bosnia Safe</i> · Facebook page · 3 reels                        |
| 3  | Local citations       | <i>Sarajevo in Two Days</i> · BiH directories submitted · GBP services linked · P1: CMS meta fields          |
| 4  | OTA launch            | <i>Day Trips Ranked</i> · GetYourGuide/Viator live (3 tours) · first 2 pitches · <b>Checkpoint 1</b>         |
| 5  | Comparison content    | <i>Sarajevo to Mostar</i> · Qwoted/SOS/Featured profiles · 2 pitches                                         |
| 6  | Food + Pinterest      | <i>What to Eat</i> · first Pinterest batch (15 pins) · P1: package FAQs · 2 pitches                          |
| 7  | Itineraries           | <i>How Many Days</i> · hotel partner asks (batch of 5) · 2 pitches                                           |
| 8  | Difficult history     | <i>Visiting Srebrenica</i> · <b>Checkpoint 2</b> · GSC striking-distance ritual → pick 3 pages to strengthen |
| 9  | Seasonality           | <i>Best Time to Visit</i> · strengthen the 3 pages · podcast pitches                                         |
| 10 | High-intent practical | <i>Airport to City</i> · second Pinterest batch · 2 pitches                                                  |
| 11 | Low season            | <i>Bosnia in Winter</i> · destination expansion continues · 2 pitches                                        |
| 12 | Wrap + compound       | <i>Ten Things I Tell Every Guest</i> · <b>Checkpoint 3</b> · write next quarter's calendar from GSC data     |

**Monday 30-minute ritual:** GSC last 7 days vs previous (clicks, new queries) → GA4 key events by channel → GBP performance (calls, directions, clicks) → reviews replied → one row in the KPI sheet.

SECTION 9

# KPIs

| METRIC                          | WK 0   | WK 4  | WK 8  | WK 12    |
|---------------------------------|--------|-------|-------|----------|
| Google reviews (count)          | record | +10   | +25   | +40      |
| GSC clicks / 28 days            | record | +15%  | +40%  | +100%    |
| GSC impressions / 28 days       | record | +25%  | +60%  | +150%    |
| Local pack, "sarajevo tours"    | record | top 3 | top 3 | #1       |
| Referring domains (Ahrefs)      | record | +2    | +6    | +10      |
| Organic+GBP begin_checkout / mo | record | +20%  | +50%  | +100%    |
| IG followers / avg reel views   | record | up    | up    | 2x views |
| Tour pages with rich results    | check  | all   | all   | all      |

Judge weeks 1–4 on **activity** (did everything ship?), weeks 5–12 on **trend** (is every line moving?). SEO compounds — this quarter keeps paying out in months 4–12.

## SECTION 10

# Tips & guardrails

- **AI search already sends you guests.** ChatGPT, Perplexity and Google's AI answers assemble from Bing's index, Reddit, TripAdvisor and review counts. Your levers: Bing Webmaster (Week 1), genuine forum answers (Section 5), review volume (Section 2), FAQ schema (done). The honest version wins here — no tricks needed.
- **Never buy links or reviews.** One penalty erases the quarter. Partner-hotel and PR links are the safe, durable kind.
- **Don't break the SEO invariants** in the README: every new page needs the SEO component plus a route entry; changed URLs need a 301; no static meta in index.html.
- **UTM discipline:** tag every off-site link you control ( `utm_source=gbp|instagram|tiktok|pinterest` ), never tag internal links — otherwise Week-12 attribution is guesswork.
- **Season reality:** July–September is high season, but content written now ranks by next spring's planning wave. The winter post and low-season GBP activity smooth revenue.
- **Prerender watch:** the Monday auto-rebuild refreshes content weekly; if a Netlify build fails, the last good deploy stays live — glance at deploy notifications during the Monday ritual.

Tallest Tourguide · tallesttourguide.com · Prepared July 2026 · Companion file: docs/seo-visibility-plan.md in the site repository